Los Angeles Times

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TRADERS at the New York Stock Exchange on Friday. Trump suggested the job tallies were "manipulated."

Trump digs in on trade war, fires official after dismal jobs report

Employment growth stalls; May and June tallies revised sharply lower

By Michael Wilner

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration is doubling down on its trade war against much of the world despite increasingly harrowing economic numbers emerging at home, with stock markets and Treasury yields tumbling Friday on news of the most significant slowdown in job growth since the pandemic.

Government data showed the U.S. economy added 73,000 jobs in July — far fewer than expected — and issued revised numbers for the prior two months that showed only 19,000 jobs were created in May, and 14,000 in June, amid widespread uncertainty over President Trump's tariff policies and deep cuts to government employment.

The unemployment numbers came a day after Trump signed an executive order increasing tariffs on 66 countries, further roiling a decades-old system of global trade.

The chair of the White House Council of Economic Advisors reacted to the unemployment report by saying the numbers are "not what we want to see." But Trump responded by directing his team to fire the commissioner of the Bureau of Labor Statistics, a nonpartisan position responsible for overseeing the statistical analysis of jobs data, suggesting the numbers were politically "manipulated." She was fired hours later.

"I was just informed that our Country's 'Jobs Numbers' are being produced by a Biden Appointee, Dr. Erika McEntarfer, the Commissioner of Labor Statistics, who faked the Jobs Numbers

[See **Trump**, A8]

Southland shops brace for duties

Small businesses say U.S. policy on Indian imports will hurt consumers. **BUSINESS, A10**

UCLA facing a federal deadline to settle claims

Justice Department froze funding, alleging Jewish students' civil rights were violated.

By Jaweed Kaleem and Daniel Miller

University of California leaders face a difficult choice after the U.S. Department of Justice said this week that UCLA had violated the civil rights of Jewish students during pro-Palestinian protests and federal agencies on Wednesday suspended more than $300 million in research grants to the school.

Do they agree to a costly settlement, potentially incurring the anger of taxpayers, politicians and campus communities in a deep-blue state that's largely opposed to President Trump and his battle to remake higher education?

Or do they go to court, entering a protracted legal fight and possibly inviting further debilitating federal actions against the nation's premier public university system, which, until now, has carefully avoided head-on conflicts with the White House?

Leaders of the University of California, including its systemwide president, James B. Milliken; UCLA Chancellor Julio Frenk and UC's 24-member Board of Regents — California Gov. Gavin Newsom is an ex-officio member — have just days to decide.

In findings issued Monday, U.S. Atty. Gen. Pam Bondi and the Justice Department said UCLA would pay a "heavy price" for acting with "deliberate indifference" to the civil rights of Jewish and Israeli students who complained of antisemitic incidents since Oct. 7, 2023. That's when Hamas attacked Israel, which led to Israel's war in Gaza and the pro-Palestinian student encampment on Royce Quad.

The Justice Department gave UC — which oversees federal legal matters for UCLA and nine other campuses — until Tuesday to respond to the allegations of antisemitism. It wrote that "unless there is reasonable certainty that we can reach an agreement" to "ensure that the hostile environment is eliminated and reasonable steps are taken to prevent its recurrence," the department

[See **UCLA**, A14]

Hydrogen may be a green energy survivor

By Hayley Smith

At a construction site along the Los Angeles River, just south of where four freeways converge in Vernon, a crane hoisted a set of massive white pipes into the air on a recent weekday morning.

The pipes will eventually be connected to fuel dispensers where they will serve as storage vessels for hydrogen — a growing yet controversial source of energy that some see as key to California's ambitious climate goals.

The site is being developed by a New Jersey-based company called Avina in partnership with Vernon Public Utilities. When completed this October, it is planned to produce up to 4 metric tons of compressed green hydrogen a day to power heavy-duty trucks and buses, helping to clean up one of the worst polluting sectors in the state.

The facility is expected to eliminate approximately 130,000 metric tons of planet-warming carbon dioxide emissions annually, according to Avina. Company officials said it will be the largest clean hydrogen project with on-site dispensing — meaning pumps where fleets can

[See **Climate**, A9]

ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

CONSTRUCTION at the Avina Clean Hydrogen Facility in Vernon, scheduled to open in the fall.

Opposition rises against Newsom's wildfire fund plan

Ratepayers and shareholders would foot $18-billion bill, prompting objections.

By Melody Petersen

Gov. Gavin Newsom's plan to make electric customers and utility shareholders share the burden of paying $18 billion more to shore up a state fund for wildfire victims faces a tough battle, with complaints from both consumer advocates and utilities.

Under Newsom's plan, customers of the state's three biggest for-profit utilities would pay $9 billion to bolster the state wildfire fund, which officials say could be depleted by damages caused by January's Eaton fire. The state fund currently contains $21 billion.

An additional $9 billion would come from shareholders of Southern California Edison, Pacific Gas & Electric and San Diego Gas & Electric, according to a draft of the proposal.

The three utilities have been lobbying in Sacramento, asking that the fund be strengthened, since January when the Eaton fire roared through Altadena after igniting under an Edison transmission tower. But utility executives say they are opposed to their shareholders paying more.

Pedro Pizarro, chief executive of Edison Interna-

[See **Wildfire fund**, A9]

Corp. for Public Broadcasting to shut down after funding cuts

By Meg James

The Corp. for Public Broadcasting said Friday it was shutting down, a week after President Trump signed legislation stripping its funding.

The move startled some public radio and television station managers throughout the country. Many had only begun to absorb the shock of losing federal support and were quickly figuring out ways to keep their stations vibrant.

The Corp. for Public Broadcasting administers funds for PBS TV affiliates and NPR radio stations — more than 1,500 local television and radio stations nationwide.

In a statement, the group said it would "begin an orderly wind-down of its operations." A majority of staff positions will be cut Sept. 30, when the group's fiscal year ends and "a small transition team will remain through January," it said.

"This reflects the devastating impacts on public broadcasting," said Andrew Russell, PBS SoCal chief executive. "CPB provides funding to local stations, it provides funding to national programming, and it has played a leadership role in public broadcasting since its inception. These are all real losses."

Since returning to office, Trump has made a priority of yanking federal funding from public broadcasters as part of a wider campaign against media outlets that he dislikes. The president derided PBS and NPR as government-funded "left-wing propaganda." Congress fell into line.

Conservatives have long wanted to strip funding from public media because of what they perceive to be liberal bias.

Lawmakers passed a "rescission" measure in mid-July, largely along party lines, that canceled $1.1 billion previously allocated for public broadcasting for two years.

"There was no offramp," said Ken Siebert, general manager of Yellowstone Public Radio in Billings, Mont. "That money had already been appropriated. It wasn't like they came and said: 'OK, you've got two

[See **Public media**, A12]

MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

HOUSING under construction and lots being cleared in Pacific Palisades in July.

After outcry, L.A. restricts duplexes in Pacific Palisades

By Liam Dillon

As rebuilding ramps up in Pacific Palisades, Los Angeles leaders are restricting the building of duplexes on single-family-home lots.

The move follows an executive order issued Wednesday by Gov. Gavin Newsom that allows exemptions for the Palisades and other areas devastated by January's Palisades and Eaton fires from Senate Bill 9. The landmark 2021 law, passed in response to the state's housing shortage, lets property owners divide single-family-home lots and build up to four units.

In recent days, Palisades residents have raised alarms about SB 9, worrying that their historically single-family-home community would be transformed by the additional density allowed under the law and become more dangerous in the event of future fires. On Jan. 7, the chaotic evacuation amid the flames led residents to abandon their cars on Sunset Boulevard and escape on foot, forcing bulldozers to clear the road so that emergency responders could enter the area.

No outcry has erupted over the addition of accessory dwelling units in the Palisades, even though they could bring similar increases in building, and have been far more common in

[See **Duplexes**, A14]

Gender-affirming care lawsuit filed

California and several other states sue over Trump's executive order threatening providers of such healthcare. **NATION, A6**

El Salvador ends term limits

Nayib Bukele's party approves constitutional changes that will allow indefinite presidential reelection. **WORLD, A3**

Mexican Mafia role is alleged

Suspected member of the gang is charged in club owner's killing. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

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L.A. Basin: 83/63. **B8**

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